



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 21

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Wood Dust Exposure & Respiratory Protection

OVERVIEW:

Wood dust has been classified as a known human carcinogen by the International Agency for Research on Cancer, particularly hardwood dust including oak, beech, and walnut. Long-term occupational exposure is linked to sinonasal cancer, a rare but serious cancer of the nasal cavity. Respiratory protection and

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Dust collection is the most effective control for wood dust. A properly connected dust collector or shop vacuum at the tool captures the majority of dust before it becomes airborne. The key word is properly connected — a hose that is partially attached, the wrong size, or connected to a full bag provides little actual protection. Check connections, check bag or canister fill levels, and check
2. Respirators are your last line of defense after dust collection and ventilation. For general wood dust, an N95 filtering facepiece provides adequate protection for occasional exposure. For sustained work generating fine dust — especially MDF, particleboard, or any exotic hardwood — a P100 half-face respirator provides significantly better protection. Make sure the respirator fits
3. Never use compressed air to blow sawdust off yourself, your clothing, or work surfaces. Compressed air blowing through fine wood dust creates a cloud of airborne particles that can remain suspended for hours and are inhaled by anyone in the area. Use a vacuum, a brush, or a damp cloth to remove dust from surfaces. This is especially important at the end of a shift when cleanup habits tend to
4. Pay attention to symptoms. Persistent sneezing, nasal congestion, eye irritation, or unusual shortness of breath during woodworking are all signs that your dust exposure may be exceeding what your body can handle. These symptoms should be reported to your supervisor, and medical evaluation should be considered. Early detection of occupational respiratory disease makes a significant

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

Q1: What respirators are available on this job, and are they the right type for the work we are doing today?

Q2: Is anyone on this crew experiencing any respiratory symptoms that might be related to wood dust exposure?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Use dust collection at the tool for all sanding and routing operations
- N95 minimum for general wood dust; P100 for MDF or exotic species
- Never use compressed air to blow dust off yourself or work surfaces
- Keep dust accumulation low — fine dust is both a health and fire hazard
- Report any persistent respiratory symptoms to your supervisor

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 21

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
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02		click to sign	17		click to sign
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